Guiding Principles and Requirements

MentorHub Knowledge Base

The Student Success Initiative (SSI) has identified a self-service database as a priority. This database will empower students by making valuable information easily accessible. Our research supports that students appreciate well-organized information that they can search to find the answers they need when they need them.

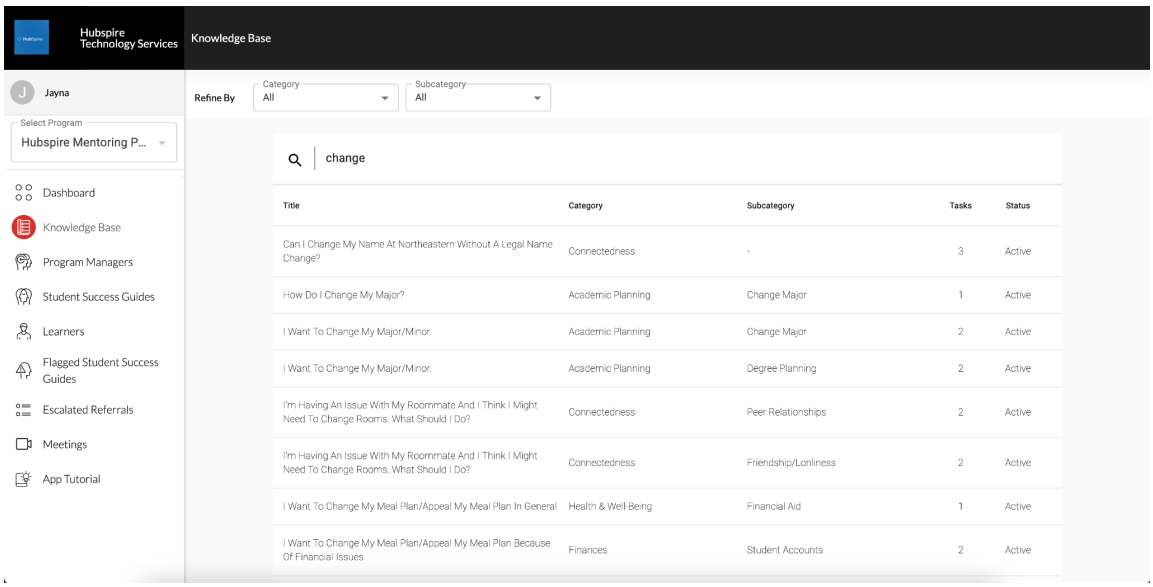
Utilizing the MentorHub application and its current knowledge base enables quick implementation and provides an extra layer of interaction that can enhance the learners' experience.

Although going this route does limit access to information — due to the need to download the application and set up an account with a password, as well as the inability to utilize Google search — those limitations may lead to the following benefits: Once downloaded, the application will not only provide them access to information publicly unavailable but will also provide additional support around that information.

The knowledge base, with our recommendations, enables MentorHub and Student Success Guides (SSGs) to guide students to the information they need when they need it.

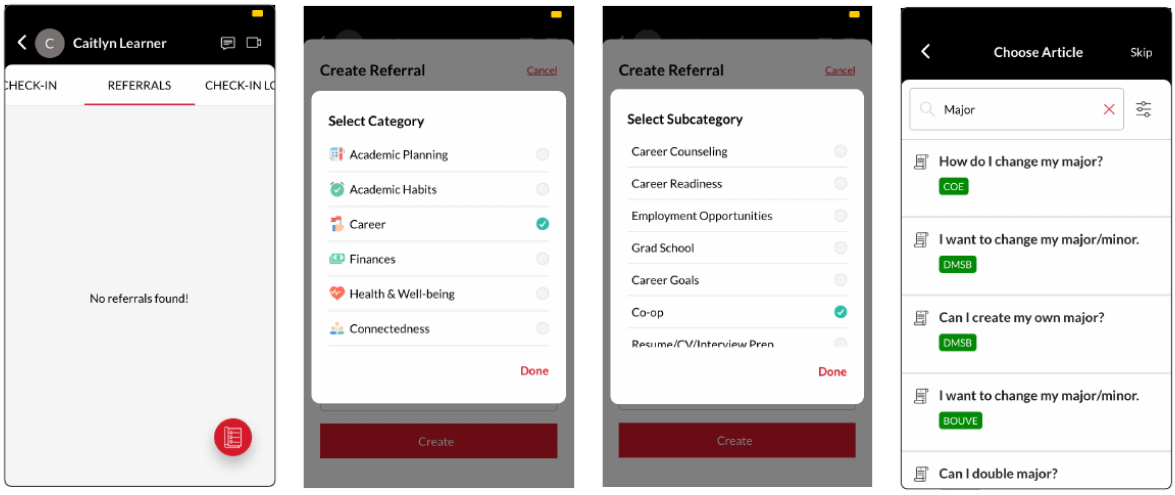
Current MentorHub knowledge base use and functionality

At this time, the MentorHub Knowledge Base is available to support coordinators to search and filter all the available information.



SSGs only interact with the knowledge base when they are providing referrals to a student. This process is different in that an SSG can't search the entire database instantly. The SSG chooses to send a referral, pick from a list of categories, and then pick again from subcategories within a category. Lastly, they can search questions or statements with various tags.

Here is an example of the process an SSG experiences…



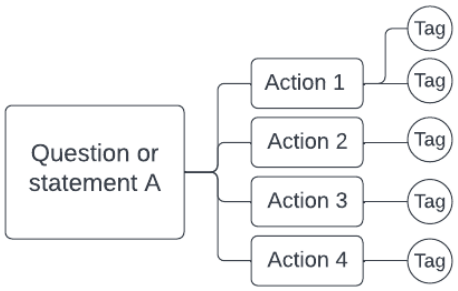
A student self-service knowledge base

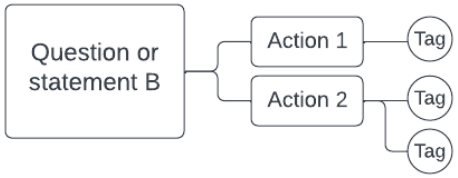
The goal is to adapt the current MentorHub knowledge base so students can use it, giving them quick, direct access to information in a self-service format, using familiar words and language. In achieving this goal, the work should also do the following:

1. Offer students the ability to find answers without the need to speak to a person every time they have a question. This is especially valuable for more personal questions, those that a student might not be comfortable expressing verbally.
2. Streamline the process so that students avoid going to multiple places to find a solution.
3. Offer students the ability to contact an SSG if they have follow-up questions or need additional support.
4. Leverage MentorHub functionality.

The Knowledge Base

Within the knowledge base, a question or statement is connected with up to five action items, identified as tasks. These tasks are called up by a referral and populated into a to-do list for a student, as well as reflected in notifications, although notifications are no longer available after the initial viewing.





For example, the statement “I want to change my major/minor” has two tasks associated with it: “Academic Advisor” and “Email advisor if they can’t get an appointment.” The tags associated with each of these tasks is DMSB.

Questions or statements

Questions or statements within the knowledge base are usually one sentence long. They are written in the first person, allowing students to feel like they are getting an answer to their question, situation, and needs. This is consistent with knowledge base formating, and we recommend keeping this format as it coincides with how students frame their needs.

Duplicative articles within search results

If a coordinator were to search for “minor” within the knowledge base or an SSG were to go to the “Academic Planning” category and then the “Degree Planning” subcategory, they would receive the following results:

- How do I declare a CAMD minor?
- How do I declare a CSSH minor?
- How do I declare a COS minor?
- How do I declare a Khoury minor?
- How do I declare a COE minor?
- How do I declare a Bouve minor?
- How do I declare a minor?

These search results are duplicative, and because there are also tags identifying colleges, the results are confusing for a learner. We recommend collapsing information so that “How do I declare a minor?” is one search result, not seven.

Once information is collapsed within one statement or article, then unique identifiers can be applied with additional information. This is further explained in the identifiers section.

Descriptions are empty

While there are description fields in the original data table, they are empty. Adding descriptions would provide valuable context and explanations for the questions or statements.

Providing descriptions with general information for students, along with specific information for colleges, programs, and offices, will provide the best experience for students, enabling them to find what they need, while also staying consistent with knowledge base format and functionality.

Students need definition questions

It is good to never assume knowledge, especially for first year students. They may not completely understand what “URF” stands for or that “NUPath” refers to required courses. Adding in a glossary of terms will be helpful. These definitions can be added as questions like “What is a co-op?” Then added to other articles as related content.

Students need related articles

With each article, provide a list of links to related questions and statements. This enables students to expand their knowledge and/or keep searching if their initial question wasn’t answered.

Students may need an SSG

At the end of each article, include a “Was it helpful” (yes/no) follow-up question. If the answer is no, then the system can refer the student to an SSG who can assist. This allows for tracking success metrics if the answer was helpful, and offers the personal connection to the SSG if not.

If SSGs have subject-matter expertise, then the student can be referred to the SSG most knowledgeable about what they are researching.

Requirements for questions or statements

- Compile all similar questions into one article statement or question, such as “How do I declare a minor?”
- Add descriptions for each question or statement.
- Add identifiers for each question or statement that contain additional information based on the identifier. For example, the question “How do I declare a minor?” would have the identifier “College of Arts, Media, and Design (CAMD)” with additional information specific to the identifier.
- Include “Was it helpful” (yes/no) follow up question at the end of each article. If the answer is “no.” refer to SSG.

Categories

The existing categories that are used in MentorHub's referral process correlate to the categories used in the learner check-in. Those categories are:

- Academic Habits
- Academic Planning
- Career
- Connectedness
- Finances
- Health & Well-being

We recommended not using the existing categories within the knowledge base in MentorHub for the following reasons.

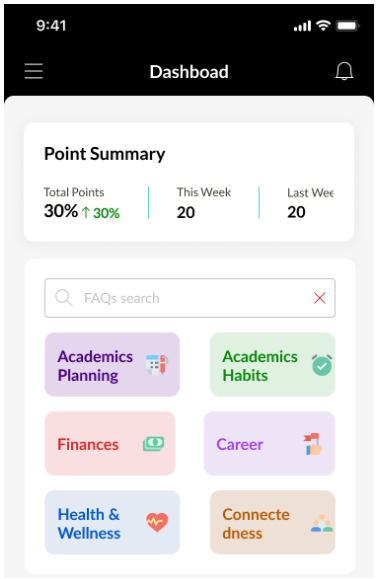
Confusion on where answers might be located
Maintaining consistency by using the MentorHub check-in categories with the knowledge base is commendable; however, it leads to confusion regarding where content is located.

For example, if a student's roommate has COVID and they want to know about other rooming options, would that fall under "Health & Well-being" or "Connectedness"?

Disconnect between category and content
Also, there are examples within the knowledge base of information being placed in a category that only has a distant relation to the content. For example, the question, "I'm Having Trouble With My Visa, What Do I Do?" is under the category "Connectedness." A student wouldn't think to look under that category to find out about visas.

If a student cannot find the relevant information quickly and easily, they will get frustrated and leave MentorHub, opting instead to use another method, like Google.

Students do not categorize their questions in the same ways
An SSG used the"career" category as an example. Students think of work-study, jobs, or post-graduation work when they see that category, rather than co-ops. However, it is this category that contains the subcategory "Co-Op."



Clicking on categories to find information
One idea discussed and designed for MentorHub v3 includes providing a list of categories as navigational buttons on the dashboard. This would require the student to click on a category to get to a list of questions or statements. It is currently unclear if they would also need to select a subcategory to get to the list.

We do not recommend using categories on the dashboard as a means for students to navigate to lists of questions within that category.

Students frequently mention that they prefer to search rather than click through a number of screens to find what they are looking for. Using Google is one of the ways they try to find desired information as quickly as possible.

We have additional recommendations for utilizing the dashboard to support student self-service, focusing primarily on search bar functionality and quicklinks to relevant knowledge. Those recommendations are available in the Additional Recommendations section.

Implications of changes to category system
We recognize that the recommended changes to the knowledge base will impact the referrals process/workflow. However, UX adjustments to adapt to those changes should be straightforward. Staff and SSGs have reported that the referral system is not used widely at this time. Students and SSGs often prefer to chat instead. Also, the self-service availability of information should decrease the need for referrals.

Requirements for categories
- Remove categories from knowledge base.
- Remove categories as organizational structure for the knowledge base. This means eliminating the concept of selecting a category to select a subcategory to get a list of questions and statements.
- Provide subject based buttons, such as clubs and events, that are quick and easy to identify on the dashboard.
- Avoid category buttons as optional navigation on dashboard.
- Avoid organizing content by department, office, or program as NU currently does with its websites, portals, etc. This structure relies on the student already knowing precisely where to go and when.

Subcategories

The existing subcategories that are used in MentorHub are the following.

Academic Planning

- Registration
- Global Experience
- Degree Planning
- Course Planning
- Holds
- Grade Appeal
- Change Major
- Remote Learning
- Accommodations
- Research Opportunities
- Experiential Learning
- Leave of Absence
- Communication
- Excused Absence
- Degree Progress
- Change School
- Honor

Career

- Co-op
- Career Goals
- Grad School
- Career Counseling
- Career Readiness
- Networking
- Resume/CV/Interview Prep
- Employment Opportunities

Academic Habits

- Professor
- Tutoring
- Study Habits
- Absences
- Research Opportunities
- Communication
- Time Management
- Goal Setting
- Courses
- Student Conduct
- Teamwork
- Learning Experiences
- Possession loss
- ITS Support
- AV/ITS Support

Health and Well-being

- Financial Aid
- Accommodations

Finances

- Registration
- Holds
- Employment Opportunities
- Financial Aid
- Student Accounts
- Student Employment
- Scholarship
- Loans

Connectedness

- Peer Relationships
- Student Activities & Events
- Husky Cards
- Friendship/Lonliness
- International Study

The organization of subcategories within categories is not always consistent or intuitive

For example, ITS Support and Possession Loss is listed under Academic Habits.

Another example is the question, “I'm having trouble with my visa, what do I do?” which is listed under Connectedness with subcategory International Study. Husky Cards are also listed under Connectedness.

Courses are within Academic Habits but Registration is listed under Finances.

This further illustrates that requiring students to narrow down results based on these categorizations — whether category or subcategories — is inefficient and problematic. The likelihood students will find what they need decreases because organization isn’t apparent.

While these descriptions may be useful as tags since they describe the type of content, we do not recommend that they be used as subcategories.

Requirements for tags

- Remove subcategories from knowledge base.
- Remove subcategories as organizational components for the knowledge base, therefore eliminating the need to select a category followed by selecting a subcategory to get a list of questions and statements.
- Use existing subcategory descriptions, with necessary modifications, as tags.
    - Break apart labels with multiple concepts such as “Resume/CV/Interview Prep” into “resume,” “CV,” “interview,” “preparation” tags.
    - Remove any unclear concepts such as “Accommodations,” which isn’t as precise as “student housing” or “apartments.” Try to be as descriptive and precise as possible when using tags to describe content.

Tasks

In the knowledge base, each question or statement is connected to a series of tasks. There can be up to five tasks per question or statement.

This was set up to support the SSG referral system.

Not all tasks use verbs

Tasks are not required but can be used within question and statement articles. But, if used, they should all be written in action sentences such as “Contact your academic advisor,” not as subjects, for example, “academic advisor.”

Students could use self-serve action for to-do items

Also, it would be beneficial to have tasks listed as a subset of information that the student can choose to add to their to do list.

Requirements for tasks

- Rewrite all tasks to use verbs (action words) to identify each task.
- If there are multiple tasks and they require step-by-step implementation, that should be pointed out and apparent in the interface.
- Enable students to add tasks or groups of tasks to their to-do lists.

Tags

Each task is associated with one or more tags. Currently, the tags are used as a way to identify tasks that are specific to a college, program, office, and others.

The following are the existing tags

- GSP
- CAMD
- CSSH
- COS
- SA
- KHOURY
- INT
- EXPLORE
- BOUVE
- OGS
- COE
- DMSB
- GSS
- NU Immerse
- Mills

These tags are a mix of colleges, offices, programs, and locations. They are also a mix of acronyms and truncated names.

Enrollment programs

- General Studies Program (GSP)
- Explore Program (Explore)
- NU Immerse

Offices

- Office of Global Services (OGS)

Colleges

- Bouvé College of Health Sciences (BOUVE)
- College of Arts, Media, and Design (CAMD)
- College of Engineering (COE)
- College of Social Sciences and Humanities (CSSH)
- College of Science (COS)
- D'Amore-McKim School of Business (DMSB)
- Khoury College of Computer Sciences (Khoury)

Mills is a women's college based out of Oakland, California. Since it is heavily location based, rather than identified as a college of specific interests like those already listed, we suggest it be identified as a satellite campus location.

At first, it appears SA stands for Student Accounts, but when reviewing content, it becomes clear the acronym stands for student athlete. However, this is the only student group identifier in the tags list. For instance, international students and veterans are not listed.

INT stands for Interdisciplinary Studies within the College of Professional Studies. It is the only time a specific area of study is identified within tags.

Global Student Success (GSS) is a program available to international students with workshops, tutoring, and more. However, unlike other enrollment programs, it is need based and student initiated. Similar programs include the Peer Tutoring Program and Global Learner Support.

Tags used for organization, not search

Each of the tags listed above are related to specific content, meaning the content is only applicable to those within the program or college. For that reason, the tags are serving an organizational purpose — like a section or folder — rather than a labeling function for search results.

We recommend repurposing tags to serve a label function, identifying important keywords that will help students searching for content.

For instance, with the question "Can I mail a package from campus?" Right now, it is tagged, "Mills." With our recommendation, instead of tagging it as "Mills," it would list "Mills" as an identifier with corresponding information. The tags would be keywords related to the content such as "UPS," "FedEx," "shipping," and "stamps." Using tags in this way will enable additional search parameters and filtering.

Tags distract from search results

Within the current SSG knowledge base and referral experience, tags appear within search results. Since the tags are used as content organization, it is necessary for the SSG to know that a task is related to a college or program. However, with our recommendation for tags as descriptors, tags should not appear in search results, only on the article page view.

Requirements for tags

- Use tags for identifying keywords helpful for search parameters.
- Remove tags that are better used as identifiers.
- Remove tags from search results list view.
- Show tags on article page view.

Identifiers

As explained above, quite a bit of content within the knowledge base is only relevant to those students within a specific college or program. Other bits of content are relevant to specific locations or the student's collegiate year.

It is important to have identifiers for this content within an article:

- Specific college (COE, CAMD, etc)
- Location (Mills, Boston, London, etc.)
- Program enrollment (N.U.in, NU Bound, etc)
- Program support (Peer Tutoring Program, Global Student Supports, etc.)
- First year, second year, etc.
- Personal (international students, disabled students, veterans, etc.)

Many of these are currently within tags; however, tags should describe content for searching, while identifiers organize and define content.

Students want personalized content

During interviews, students shared concerns about being uncertain of what applies to them — whether it be a specific event or more general information. Using identifiers to match student profiles will assist in making sure the right information, personalized information, is prioritized above other information — while still keeping all information accessible.

Prepopulating their profile from their banner record is an additional way to ensure that identifiers are correct; however, be sure to include directions on how to get that information updated if it is not. We have heard from students that the banner record is not always immediately accurate. Sometimes it can take just a day for changes to appear but, in other situations depending on the data, it can take longer.

Requirements for identifiers

- Connect question or statement with content using identifiers.
- Identifiers should be grouped by type of identifier.
    - Specific college (COE, CAMD, etc.)
    - Location based (Mills, Boston, London, etc.)
    - Program enrollment based (N.U.in, NU Bound, etc.)
    - Program support based (Peer Tutoring Program, Global Student Supports, etc.)

    - First year, second year, etc.
    - Personal (international students, disabled students, veterans, etc)
- Content specific to an identifier should be grouped with the identifier within the correct article. For example, the details on how a COE student can change their major should be listed under the “How do I change my major?” article.

Search

We are aware that the MentorHub dashboard will be revised to include a search field, which will be the student's access point to the self-service knowledgebase. We think this is great placement as it offers easy access once the user is in the app.

By providing a search function, as well as the top three to five FAQs questions or statements students currently seek, students will be able to access the knowledge they need, when they need it.

As stated previously, we do not recommend using the existing categories on the dashboard as quicklinks.

Search parameters only include article title

Current search results of the knowledge base are limited to article titles.

We recommended that search results encompass all available data within the knowledge base for optimal search results.

When a student searches the knowledge base, the system should search title, description, tasks, identifiers, identifier content, identifier tasks, and tags.

Search should be able to find sentences, sentence fragments, acronyms, and tags.

Also, search should not be uppercase or lowercase dependent.

Search results are not student specific

Search results should be tailored to and prioritized by identifiers either pulled from Banner or disclosed by the student within the student profile.

Contents are not optimized for searching

Enhanced search features are definitely recommended but they only represent half of the work needed to assist students in finding what they are searching for. Content optimization is also needed.

Within content, always provide all versions of a college, program, and office.

- spelled out
- acronyms
- shortened versions

Also be sure to include any terminology that students use when discussing the article subject, either within the content itself or as a tag.

Here are some examples of variant terminology and language used by students.

- Clubs (rather than “student groups” or “student organizations”)
- First year learners (instead of Freshmen)
- Learners (instead of students)
- Career (students don’t use this term in relation to co-ops, use it in relation to jobs to post grad)

Requirements for search

- Provide search field in dashboard for easy lookup.
- Provide the top three to five questions or statements in dashboard as quicklinks.
- Enable search for multiple parameters and content, not just the “article title.”
    - When a student searches the knowledge base, the system should search title, description, tasks, identifiers, identifier content, identifier tasks, and tags.
    - Search should be able to find sentences, sentence fragments, acronyms, and tags.
    - Also, search should not be uppercase or lowercase dependent.
- Prioritize information based on identifiers pulled from Banner or disclosed by student within student profile.
- Optimize content
    - Provide all versions of a college, program, and office: spelled out, acronyms, and shortened versions.
    - Include any terminology that students use when discussing the article subject, either within the content itself or as a tag.

Summary of requirements

Student self-service knowledge base and experience

I. **Questions or statements**
   A. Compile all similar questions into one article statement or question, such as “How do I declare a minor?”
   B. Add descriptions for each question or statement.
   C. Add identifiers for each question or statement that contain additional information based on the identifier. For example, the question “How do I declare a minor?” would have the identifier “College of Arts, Media, and Design (CAMD)” with additional information specific to the identifier.
   D. Include “Was it helpful” (yes/no) follow up question at the end of each article. If the answer is “no,” refer to SSG.

II. **Categories**
   A. Remove categories from knowledge base.
   B. Remove categories as an organizational structure for the knowledge base. This means eliminating the concept of selecting a category to select a subcategory to get a list of questions and statements.
   C. Provide subject based buttons, such as clubs and events, that are quick and easy to identify on the dashboard.
   D. Avoid category buttons as optional navigation on the dashboard.
   E. Avoid organizing content by department, office, or program as NU currently does with its websites, portals, etc. This structure relies on the student already knowing precisely where to go and when.

III. **Tags**
   A. Remove subcategories from knowledge base.
   B. Remove subcategories as organizational components for the knowledge base, therefore eliminating the need to select a category followed by selecting a subcategory to get a list of questions and statements.
   C. Use existing subcategory descriptions, with necessary modifications, as tags.
      1. Break apart labels with multiple concepts such as “Resume/CV/Interview Prep” into “resume,” “CV,” “interview,” “preparation” tags.
      2. Remove any unclear concepts such as “Accommodations,” which isn’t as precise as “student housing” or “apartments.” Try to be as descriptive and precise as possible when using tags to describe content.

IV. Tasks

A. Rewrite all tasks to use verbs (action words) to identify each task.
B. If there are multiple tasks and they require step-by-step implementation, that should be pointed out and apparent in the interface.
C. Enable students to add tasks or groups of tasks to their to-do lists.

V. Tags

A. Use tags for identifying keywords helpful for search parameters.
B. Remove tags that are better used as identifiers.
C. Remove tags from search results list view.
D. Show tags on article page view.

VI. Identifiers

A. Connect question or statement with content using identifiers.
B. Identifiers should be grouped by type of identifier.
    1. Specific college (COE, CAMD, etc.)
    2. Location base (Mills, Boston, London, etc.)
    3. Program enrollment base (N.U.in, NU Bound, etc.)
    4. Program support base (Peer Tutoring Program, Global Student Supports, etc.)
    5. First year, second year, etc.
    6. Personal (international students, disabled students, veterans, etc.)
C. Content specific to an identifier should be grouped with the identifier within the correct article. For example, the details on how a COE student can change their major should be listed under “How do I change my major?” article.

VII. Search

A. Provide search field in dashboard for easy lookup.
B. Provide the top three to five questions or statements in dashboard as quicklinks.
C. Enable search for multiple parameters and content, not just the “article title.”
    1. When a student searches the knowledge base, the system should search title, description, tasks, identifiers, identifier content, identifier tasks, and tags.
    2. Search should be able to find sentences, sentence fragments, acronyms, and tags.
    3. Also, search should not be uppercase or lowercase dependent.
D. Prioritize information based on identifiers pulled from Banner or disclosed by the student within the student profile.
E. Optimize content.
    1. Provide all versions of a college, program, and office: spelled out, acronyms, and shortened versions.

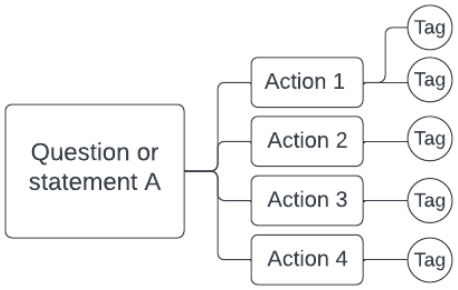
        2. Include any terminology that students use when discussing the article subject, either within the content itself or as a tag.

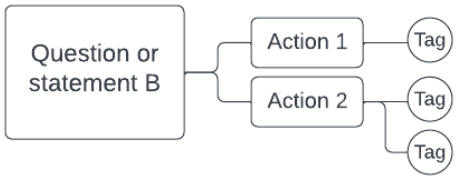
VIII. **Organization of information**

A. Question or statement.
B. General description and context.
C. General tasks.
D. Identifiers.
    1. Information specific to identifier.
    2. Tasks specific to identifier.
E. Tags.

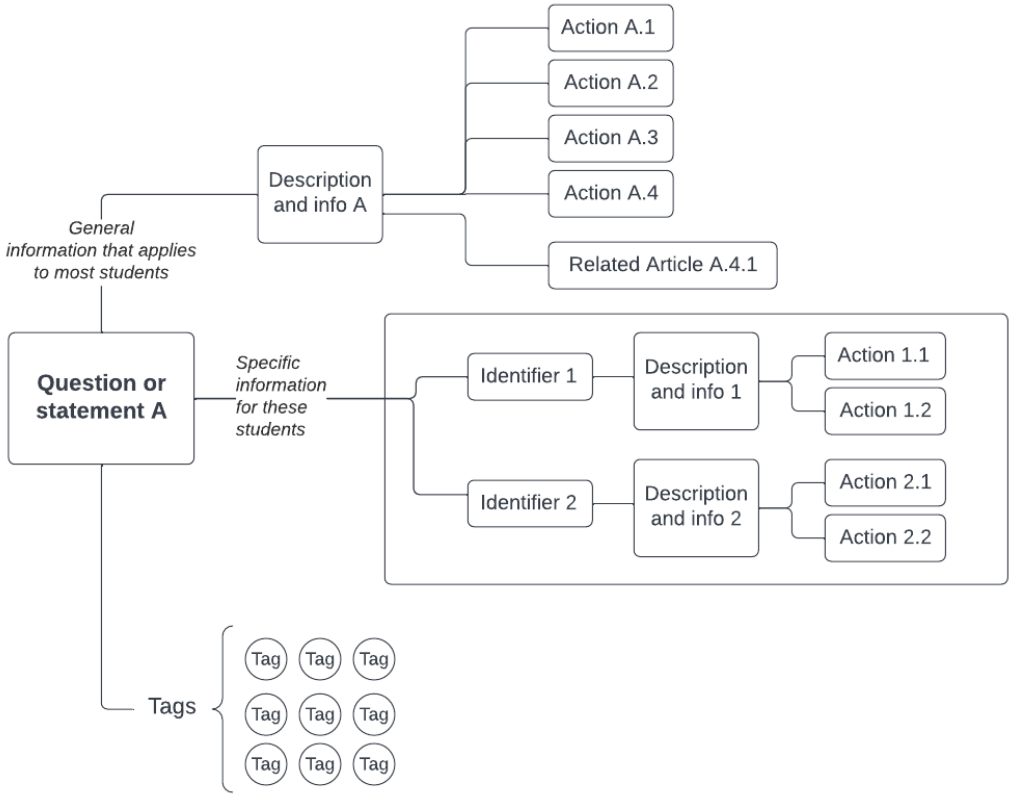
Implementation of requirements

Current knowledge base

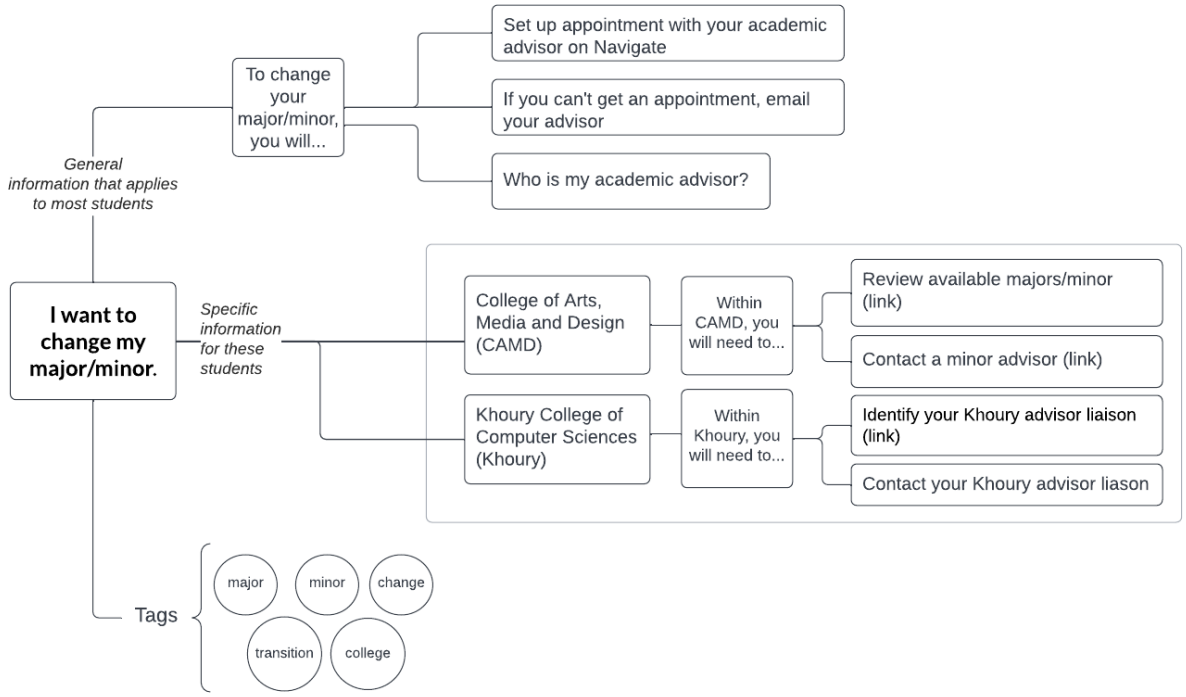




Knowledge base with recommended changes

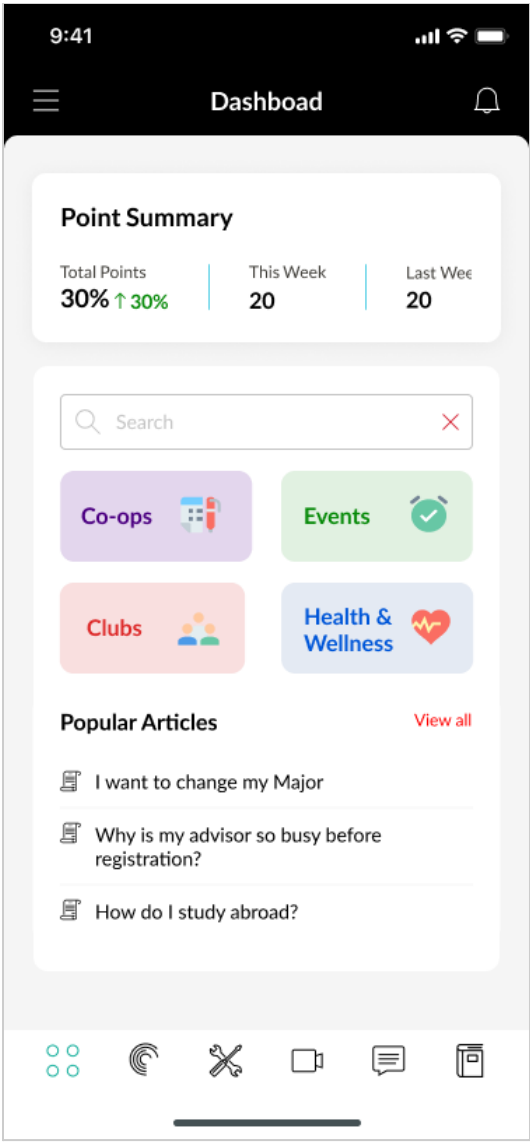


Content example for recommended changes to knowledge base



Example of student self-serve experience

Implementation of recommendations for content



How do I register for classes? Share

How do I register for classes?

Description goes here about what registration is and why it is important. Articles you may want to review before registration. Have you talked with your academic advisor first?

Step by step

Within Student Hub
Select the Resources Tab > Academic Classes & Registration > Course Registration to access the registration menu

- [ ] Create a plan
  https://registrar.northeastern.edu/wp-content/uploads/sites/9/Planning-Document-1-2.pdf
- [ ] Register for a plan

  Register by Searching for or Entering CRNs
  Registering for a Class with a Waitlist

+ Add all items to your to-do list

▸ **Additional information**

▸ **Office of the University Registrar**

COLLEGES

▸ **College of Science**

PROGRAMS

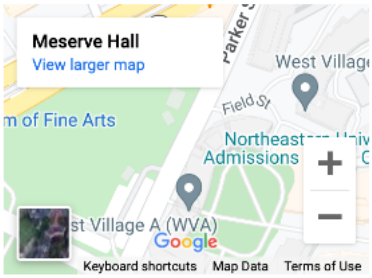
▾ **General Studies Program**

Students attend

General Studies office hours

8:30-4:30

Meserve Hall 360 Huntington Ave. Boston, MA



+ Download contact and map info

Related topics

- How do I add a course after add/drop?

Did this article answer your question?

Yes No

Recommendations

To further aid the student self-service support experience, we recommend providing students with quicklinks in the dashboard view, allowing immediate access to areas of interest. These areas should be subject based, immediately identifiable, and change depending on students' top concerns.

1. Co-ops
2. Events
3. Clubs
4. Health

Clubs

“Clubs” or “Student Organizations” deserves its own section due to the importance of student connections. As we learned in our interviews, students who participated in clubs benefited from networking, friendships, mentor/mentee relationships as well as academic and non-academic insights.

Current functionality

According to Engage, there are 540 clubs currently available to students. There is not a clear, easy way to tell which clubs are currently active, so we are assuming that all 540 are. The current 16 filters, which are also used in Student Hub, are limiting and don’t use clear language familiar to students. For example, “Academic Enrichment,” “Competition and Skill Based,“ or “Special Interest” give little insight into what types of clubs would fall within the category. The current filters are:

1. Academic Enrichment
2. Advocacy and Global Impact
3. Club Sports
4. Competition and Skill Based
5. Creative and Visual Arts
6. Fraternity/Sorority
7. Graduate
8. International and Cultural
9. Northeastern Community Connection
10. Outdoor Adventure and Wellness
11. Performing Arts
12. Philanthropic and Community Engagement
13. Political Action

14. Print and Broadcast Media
15. Religious and Spiritual
16. Special Interest

Northeastern Cultural Life categorizes some of the same clubs as Engage. For example, NU Italian Culture Society was found only through Cultural Life and is not listed in Engage. Cultural Life organizes clubs into the following categories:

1. Student Associations
2. University Resources
3. Spiritual/Religious Clubs
4. Activism and Advocacy
5. Cultural Fraternities and Sororities
6. Dance Troupes
7. Cultural Clubs

Recommended functionality

Ideally, all clubs could be discoverable through a single access point with helpful filters. We recommend there be an initial check for active clubs, and any inactive clubs (no meetings in the past 6 months to a year) be removed from the list. We are also recommending that, in addition to reviewing — and possibly revising — the current filters, consider adding the following:

1. College.

   Each college has a list of associated clubs. For example, Bouve College of Health Sciences Student Groups lists the following:

   a. American Cancer Society at NU
   b. Global Health Forum
   c. Global Medical Brigades
   d. Minority Association of Pre-health Students (MAPS)
   e. NU American Medical Women's Association
   f. NU Emergency Medical Services (Interest Group)
   g. NU Physical Therapy Club
   h. NU Pre-Dental Association
   i. NU Speech Language and Hearing Association
   j. NU Undergraduate Speech and Hearing Club
   k. Pre Physician Assistant Society

2. Specific programs.

   For example, PreMed/PreHealth (PMPH) lists the following.

   a. Alpha Epsilon Delta (The National Health Preprofessional Honor Society)
   b. American Medical Student Association (NU AMSA)
   c. American Medical Women's Association (AMWA)
   d. Minority Association of Pre-Health Students (MAPS)
   e. Pre-Dental Association
   f. Pre-Physician Assistant Society (Pre-PA Society)
   g. Pre-Veterinary Club (NUPVC)
   h. The Student Osteopathic Medical Association (Pre-SOMA)

3. Meeting day and time.

   Since students' social lives are dictated by their class or co-op schedules, it would be beneficial to be able to see what clubs meet when they are free, for example, on Tuesdays at 7pm.

4. Meeting locations.

   Online, in-person, or hybrid. This allows students who are off-campus or abroad to participate and build connections with on-campus clubs. For example, the Computer Science Mentoring Organization is a hybrid model and offers an on-campus location and a tinyurl link to join.

5. Search by acronym.

   Since most students refer to the clubs in the abbreviated form, i.e., AMSA, NUBAC, and CHAARG, it would be beneficial to enable searching by acronym.

6. Filter by type of club.

   One student expressed that she organizes types of clubs by skills based vs. networking vs. fun. Other students mentioned clubs that involved physical fitness and exercise, such as ballroom dancing or CHAARG. These might also be useful filters to add.

Events

The events calendar should include:

1. Academic calendar and deadlines.

   Students repeatedly identified academics as their highest priority. The current academic calendar is only available as a pdf, and SSI has identified it as a known pain point. At a minimum, any events calendar should display academic events. *Note: Concentric Sky has already provided a digitized version of the academic calendar.*

2. Social events and activities.

   To balance out academics, we recommend including social events and activities on the events calendar.

   Social events mentioned in interviews include:

   a. Club fairs such as Fall Fest and Winter Involvement Fair.
   b. Welcome Week. This seems obvious, but one first-year student was unaware of these activities, learning via social media. Ideally, this would be advertised and open to all students arriving on campus for the first time in fall semester.
   c. NU athletic events. We learned in Discovery 2, Part 1 that student athletes felt a lack of marketing and communications support for athletic events from NU. Adding NU athletic events to the calendar could be one way to promote these events to other students.
   d. On-campus multi-cultural events or celebrations. For example, Chinese New Year, Diwali, Hanukkah, Holi, or breaking the fast of Ramadan.
   e. Student life traditions from https://studentlife.northeastern.edu/traditions/. These were mentioned by an RA.
   f. Program-specific events:
      i. The Explore Program's Meet the Majors Fair, College Conversations, and What's in a Major.
      ii. N.U.in welcome week activities for students returning to campus. Ideally, this would be advertised and open to all students arriving on campus for the first time in spring semester. For example, international and Global ConnEXions students in addition to N.U.in.